

8.5.1 Causes of Flood

Following are some of the most common causes of flood.

- Heavy rains
- Overflow rivers
- Broken dams
- Storm surges and Tsunami
- Melting snow and ice

8.5.2 Effects of Flood

- Economic loss to farmers as agricultural lands, crops being submerged in water.
- They wreck houses, particularly kuccha houses in villages.
- They causes disruption of all types of transport and communication.
- There is a shortage of drinking water.
- They harm human, animal and plant life.
- They cause a rise in epidemics because of water logging (like Malaria, Diarrhoea, etc.)



Malpa Landslide

The Malpa Landslide was one of the worst landslide in India. On 18th Aug 1998 at 3.00AM. the massive landslide wiped away the entire village of Malpa Landslide in the Pithoragarh District of Uttarakhand.



8.5.3 Precaution to be taken

During flood

- Seek higher ground.
- Be aware of flash flood areas such as canals, streams, drainage channels.
- Be ready to evacuate.
- Don't touch electrical equipment if wet.
- If you must leave your home, do not walk through moving water.
- Do not drive over a flooded road.

After flood

- Stay away from flood water.
- Do not attempt to swim, walk or drive through the area.
- Be aware of areas where water has reduced. Road ways may have weakened and could collapse.
- Avoid downed power lines and muddy waters where power lines may have fallen.
- Do not drink tap water until advised by the health unit.
- Flood contaminated rooms have to be thoroughly cleaned and disinfected.
- Floor drains and sumps have to be cleaned and disinfected.

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